2. Sir George Cunningham, Governor Designate, NWFP
3. Maj. Gen. Scott, Commander-in-Chief Jammu and Kashmir state forces
4. Col. Roger Bacon, Political Agent, Gilgit Agency
5. Brig. D. H. J. Williams, Indian Army at Peshawar
6. Ram Chandra Kak, Prime Minister of Jammu and Kashmir
7. Maj. William Brown, Commandant Designate, Gilgit Scouts
8. Capt. Jock Mathieson, Dy. Commandant Designate, Gilgit Scouts
9. Mohammed Ali Jinnah
10. Abdul Qayyum Khan, Chief Minister, NWFP, from 23 August 1947

The following day, the Raja of Puniyal, the Governor of Koh-e-Khizr, one Ishkoman from the Khuswaqt family of Chitral and Raja Mehboob of Yasin had a series of closed-door meetings with Col. Bacon and Maj. Brown. All of these men were made privy to the events that were to unfold if Hari Singh acceded to India.

While this conspiracy was being put in place, what were Lord Mountbatten and Nehru doing? Undoubtedly, Mountbatten had guardedly discussed his apprehensions about Srinagar and the layers of intrigue shrouding it. There is available evidence that Mountbatten shared his apprehensions with Nehru and Sardar Patel and sensed some trouble brewing in Gilgit. Between the three of them, Mountbatten, Nehru and Patel persuaded Mahatma Gandhi into meeting with the Maharaja in Srinagar as a final effort to persuade the Maharaja to accede to India.[15]

Hari Singh Gets Back Gilgit

On 1 August 1947, a day after the Gilgit lease was rescinded, two significant events happened in Jammu and Kashmir.[16] Up in the north in Gilgit, an Avro Anson aircraft landed at 10:00 AM. The first to disembark was Maj. Gen. Scott, followed by the Governor Designate Brig. Ghansara Singh and Capt. M. Said of the Jammu and Kashmir state forces. The next day, the ceremonial handover was completed. Maj. Gen. Scott, Col. Bacon and Maj. Brown reportedly fine-tuned the various options for the Gilgit